# GenAI vs. the Duplex


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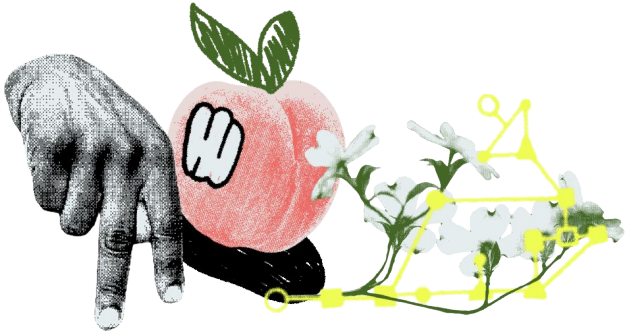

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# What is ChatGPT, the artificial intelligence text bot that went viral?

The chatbot composes Shakespearean poetry, tells jokes and writes computer code.

TECHNOLOGY

# ChatGPT's Biggest Foe: Poetry

How the machines miss threats smuggled inside lines of verse

# Sonnet or Not, Bot? Poetry Evaluation for Large Models and Datasets

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# Does ChatGPT Have a Poetic Style?

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**Abstract**

Generating poetry has become a popular application of LLMs, p
used chatbot ChatGPT. What kind of poet is ChatGPT? Does Cha
it successfully produce poems in *different* styles? To answer the
and GPT-4 models to generate English-language poems in 24 di
40 different subjects, and in response to 3 different writing pro
resulting 5.7k poems, comparing them to a sample of 3.7k poems
Academy of American Poets. We find that the GPT models, espec
poems in a range of both common and uncommon English-langua
ways, such as by producing poems of appropriate lengths for sonn
sestinas (39 lines). But the GPT models also exhibit their own dis
and outside of these specific forms. Our results show that GPT
uniform than human poetry, showing a strong penchant for rhy
meter, first-person plural perspectives (we, us, our), and specif
"echo," and "whisper."

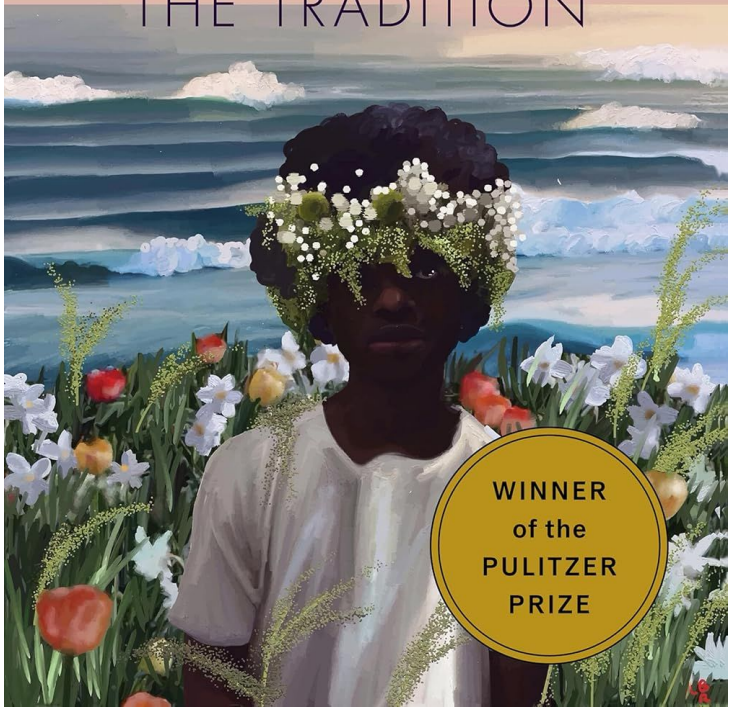
**Keywords**

LLMs, ChatGPT, poetry, style, form, text generation

## 1. Introduction

JERICHO BROWN

# THE TRADITION



WINNER of the PULITZER PRIZE

# Duplex

A poem is a gesture toward home.
It makes dark demands I call my own.

Memory makes demands darker than my own:
My last love drove a burgundy car.

My first love drove a burgundy car.
He was fast and awful, tall as my father.

Steadfast and awful, my tall father
Hit hard as a hailstorm. He'd leave marks.

Light rain hits easy but leaves its own mark
Like the sound of a mother weeping again.

Like the sound of my mother weeping again,
No sound beating ends where it began.

None of the beaten end up how we began.
A poem is a gesture toward home.

# Duplex

The duplex is a poetic form invented by poet Jericho Brown that subverts or is a "mash-up" of older poetic forms, such as the pantoum, the sonnet, and the ghazal. Brown first used this form in his third collection, *The Tradition* (Copper Canyon Press, 2019), which won the Pulitzer Prize for Poetry. In his blog post, "Invention," which was featured on *Harriet Books*, Brown writes, "I decided to call the form a duplex because something about its repetition and its couplets made me feel like it was a house with two addresses. It is, indeed, a mutt of a form as so many of us in this nation are only now empowered to live fully in all of our identities." In the same essay, Brown defines the boundaries of the duplex:

> Write a ghazal that is also a sonnet that is also a blues poem of 14 lines, giving each line 9 to 11 syllables.
>
> The first line is echoed in the last line.
>
> The second line of the poem should change our impression of the first line in an unexpected way.
>
> The second line is echoed and becomes the third line.
>
> The fourth line of the poem should change our impression of the third line in an unexpected way.
>
> This continues until the penultimate line becomes the first line of the couplet that leads to the final (and first) line.
>
> For the variations of repeated lines, it is useful to think of the a a' b scheme of the blues form.

For an example of the form, see Jericho Brown's poem "Duplex (A poem is a gesture toward home)."

# Duplex

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None of the beaten end up how we began.
A poem is a gesture toward home.

# Prompts

**General:** Write a poem about the subject of {subject} and in the form of a duplex.
**Figurative:** Write a poem about the subject of {subject} and in the form of a duplex. Do not use the words {subject} or “duplex” in the poem.
**Specific:** Write a poem about the subject of {subject} and in the form of a duplex. Make it about something specific.
**Brown’s Rules:** Write a poem about the subject of {subject} and in the form of a duplex, as defined by Jericho Brown. You must use ALL of the following rules:

- Write a ghazal that is also a sonnet that is also a blues poem of 14 lines, giving each line 9 to 11 syllables.
- The first line is echoed in the last line.
- The second line of the poem should change our impression of the first line in an unexpected way.
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- The fourth line of the poem should change our impression of the third line in an unexpected way.
- This continues until the penultimate line becomes the first line of the couplet that leads to the final (and first) line.
- For the variations of repeated lines, it is useful to think of the a a’ b scheme of the blues form.

# Subjects

abuse, activities, ancestors, arts & sciences, christianity, chronic illness, crime & punishment, cycles, desire & passion, doubt & contemplation, family & ancestors, gender & sexuality, greek & roman mythology, history & politics, home life, hope, humor & satire, indoor activities, life choices, lgbtq+, living, love, love death avoidance, memory & nostalgia, men & women, mythology & folklore, nature, power, poetry & poets, race & ethnicity, relationships, romantic love, sorrow & grieving, social commentaries, subjugation, the mind, trees and flowers, truth, twilight, urban environment, war & conflict, weather, youth

# Sonnet

A 14-line poem with a variable rhyme scheme originating in Italy and brought to England by Sir Thomas Wyatt and Henry Howard, earl of Surrey in the 16th century. Literally a "little song," the sonnet traditionally reflects upon a single sentiment, with a clarification or "turn" of thought in its concluding lines. There are many different types of sonnets.

The *Petrarchan sonnet*, perfected by the Italian poet Petrarch, divides the 14 lines into two sections: an eight-line stanza (octave) rhyming ABBAABBA, and a six-line stanza (sestet) rhyming CDCDCD or CDECDE. John Milton's "When I Consider How my Light Is Spent" and Elizabeth Barrett Browning's "How Do I Love Thee" employ this form.

The *Italian sonnet* is an English variation on the traditional Petrarchan version. The octave's rhyme scheme is preserved, but the sestet rhymes CDDCEE. See Thomas Wyatt's "Whoso List to Hunt, I Know Where Is an Hind" and John Donne's "If Poisonous Minerals, and If That Tree."

Wyatt and Surrey developed the *English (or Shakespearean) sonnet*, which condenses the 14 lines into one stanza of three quatrains and a concluding couplet, with a rhyme scheme of ABABCDCDEFEFGG (though poets have frequently varied this scheme; see Wilfred Owen's "Anthem for Doomed Youth"). George Herbert's "Love (II)," Claude McKay's "America," and Molly Peacock's "Altruism" are English sonnets.

# Glossary of Poetic Terms

## Ghazal

(Pronunciation: "guzzle") Originally an Arabic verse form dealing with loss and romantic love, medieval Persian poets embraced the ghazal, eventually making it their own. Consisting of syntactically and grammatically complete couplets, the form also has an intricate rhyme scheme. Each couplet ends on the same word or phrase (the *radif*), and is preceded by the couplet's rhyming word (the *qafia,* which appears twice in the first couplet). The last couplet includes a proper name, often of the poet's. In the Persian tradition, each couplet was of the same meter and length, and the subject matter included both erotic longing and religious belief or mysticism. English-language poets who have composed in the form include Adrienne Rich, John Hollander, and Agha Shahid Ali; see Ali's "Tonight" and Patricia Smith's "Hip-Hop Ghazal."

# Glossary of Poetic Terms

## Blues poem

The blues poem is a form that originates in African American oral and musical traditions. A blues poem typically follows a form wherein the first line presents a statement, the second offers a variation on that statement, and the third introduces an ironic alternative.

Ralph Ellison noted that, while blues often reflect struggle and depression, they also convey a spirit of determination to overcome adversity. This resilience is a defining feature of blues poetry.

See Langston Hughes's "The Weary Blues," Sterling A. Brown's "Riverbank Blues," and Cornelius Eady's "I'm a Fool to Love You."

## GenAI vs. the Duplex → off we go!

https://bit.ly/WilkesDuplex